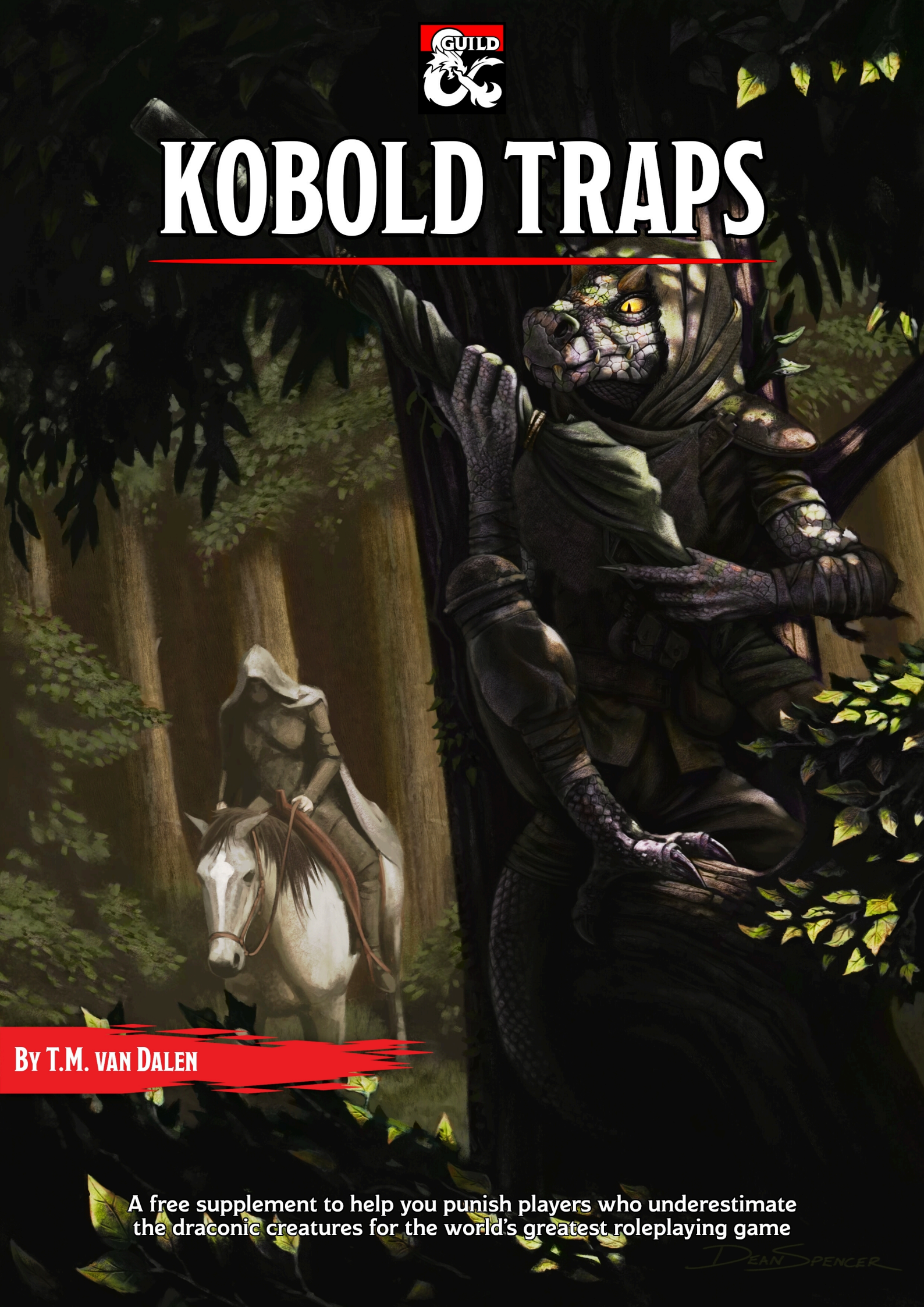

GUILD
KOBOLD TRAPS
By T.M. van Dalen
A free supplement to help you punish players who underestimate the draconic creatures for the world's greatest roleplaying game
Dean Spencer

Kobolds are one of the weakest creatures in all of Dungeons & Dragons. That is, until you encounter them in their lairs. The ingenuity of kobolds means that any adventurer that steps into a kobold lair unprepared will certainly meet their doom!

If it comes to it, an individual kobold will not think twice about laying down their life so the rest of the tribe can escape.

This free supplement is an extract from Veratrem's Tribal Siege, designed to help you fill your dungeons with interesting traps. In the full adventure, an ambitious **young green dragon** (MM p.94) has taken over a local tribe of kobolds and plans to destroy a nearby village. If you're interested in getting the full story (plus two hill giants that ambush traveling merchants along the Long Road), check out the full adventure. Readers of this product get a 25% discount!

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Kobold Traps

The traps below will work in almost any dungeon, but shine especially in tight spaces.

All tunnels are small, only a foot wide in the most narrow sections and about 3-foot-wide in the widest sections. Medium and larger creatures will have to squeeze (PHB p.192) to fit in the tunnels. Small and larger creatures will have to move single file.

The ceilings in the tunnels are about 5-foot-high. Creatures that are larger than that will have to squeeze to move through the tunnels. The ceilings in the caves are domed and about 10-foot-high in the center of the room.

Alarm

The tunnel to this cave is trapped with a pressure plate hidden in some loose sand that's connected to a bell alarm in the cave. When a creature that weighs more than 40 pounds walks through the tunnel, the pressure plate activates and the kobolds inside are warned. The pressure plate can be spotted with a DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check. When spotted, a DC 15 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check must be made to attempt to cross the tunnel without setting off the plate.

Read the following text:

> As you take another step in the narrow tunnel, you suddenly hear a small "click" from under your feet. From the cave ahead, you can hear the sound of a bell going off. Before you can react, you see a shadow darting across your vision.

Caltrops

The ground in this 5-foot-long section of tunnel is made of soft clay that covers a number of caltrops.

Any creature weighing more than 40 pounds that enters the section must succeed on a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or stop moving and





take 1 piercing damage. Until the creature regains at least 1 hit point, its walking speed is reduced by 10 feet. A creature moving through the section at half speed doesn't need to make the saving throw.

Collapsing Ceiling

The kobolds have weakened the structure of this tunnel, allowing it to collapse easily when the scaffolding here is removed. Attached to the scaffolding is a 20-foot-rope that leads to a nearby cave.

A creature can use an action to activate the trap by pulling the rope. When the roof collapses, a creature standing in the area beneath the unstable section must succeed on a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 22 (4d10) bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. Once the trap is triggered, the floor of the area is filled with rubble and becomes difficult terrain.

Holes in the Ceiling

The ceiling in this area is open to an area a level up in two spots, marked on the map with barrels. A DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check reveals the two holes, but not their purpose.

When the kobolds above see any creature that isn't a kobold pass in one of these spots, they dump a barrel of boiling oil down through the hole. The creature must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 22 (4d10) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Once the kobolds above have dumped oil in one of the spots the oil leaves behind a stain on the ground below, until the kobolds can clean it up.

Insects from Above

This 10-foot-long section of tunnel has a 30-foot-high ceiling. High up, hidden in the walls, are two ledges with 2 **winged kobolds** (MM p.195) on them.

When intruders walk past, the winged kobolds attempt to surprise them and drop two crates, each filled with a **swarm of centipedes** (MM p.338), on them. A creature walking below must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or take 1d6 bludgeoning damage from the falling crate. After the crates fall, the centipedes fall out and attack the characters.

When a character first walks into the area, read the following text:

> You walk into an area of the tunnel with a higher ceiling. Cautiously looking upwards, you see only darkness.
>
> Suddenly, two crates come crashing down on you, seemingly from out of nowhere.

After the first round of combat, on initiative count 20 (losing ties), two **kobolds** (MM p.195) herding two **swarms of rats** (MM p.339) join the fight from around a corner.

Net Trap

This tunnel, that leads to the throne room, is trapped with a falling net, suspended from the ceiling.

The trip wire is 3 inches off the ground and stretches between two wooden beams. The net is hidden by cobwebs. The DC to spot the trip wire and net is 10. A successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools breaks the trip wire harmlessly. A character without thieves' tools can attempt this check with disadvantage using any edged weapon or edged tool. On a failed check, the trap triggers.

When the trap is triggered, the net is released, covering a 5-foot-square area. A creature in that area is trapped under the net and restrained, and if it fails a DC 10 Strength saving throw it is also knocked prone. A creature can use its action to make a DC 10 Strength check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. The net has AC 10 and 5 hit points. Destroying the net frees any creature trapped in it.

Small poke holes

This tunnel runs parallel to another, larger tunnel to the east of it. Every few feet, there is a tiny hole through which a kobold can poke a needle-like dagger.

The tiny holes can be spotted with a DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check.

There are six **kobolds** (MM p.195) in the hallway, each with such a dagger. When the adventurers are all in the hallway, the kobolds attack. If the party did not spot the holes in the wall, they are surprised.

Remember that Medium or larger creatures must squeeze through the tunnels. The kobolds can reach the entire tunnel and can thus take an opportunity attack whenever a creature attempts to move past the holes.

Spiked Pit

A pit has been constructed in this tunnel. The pit cover has been well hidden, but a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check reveals a slight difference in color (if made by a creature that can discern color) in the material of the tunnel floor in this section. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check is necessary to confirm that the trapped section of tunnel is actually the cover of a pit.

When a creature that weighs more than 40 pounds steps on the cover, it swings open like a trapdoor, causing the intruder to spill into the pit below. The pit is 20 feet deep and has sharpened iron spikes at the bottom. A creature falling into the pit takes 11 (2d10) piercing damage from the spikes, in addition to 7 (2d6) falling damage.

What's Next?

Enjoyed the traps here? Why not check out Veratrem's Tribal Siege with a 25% discount to get the full story or sign up to my mailing list.

Credits

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